curriculum vitæ of
Aamir Sohail

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Last updated: September 17th, 2026

Education

2023 – 2027 **Ph.D.** in Psychology — University of Birmingham
Thesis title: *Social learning in humans and machines*
Advisors: Dr. Lei Zhang, Prof. Patricia L. Lockwood

– **Visiting Student Researcher** — Stanford University
Supervisors: Prof. Russell A. Poldrack, Prof. Robb Willer

2017 – 2018 **M.Sc.** in Brain Imaging First-class honours. — University of Nottingham
Thesis advisors: Dr. Claudia Danielmeier, Dr. Jan Derrfuss

2013 – 2016 **B.Sc.** in Biomedical Science Upper second-class honours. — Imperial College London
Thesis advisors: Prof. Anne R. Lingford-Hughes, Dr Samuel P. Turton

Employment

Dec 2023 – **Post Graduate Teaching Assistant** — University of Birmingham
School of Psychology, University of Birmingham
Line Manager: Dr. Steven Frisson

Jul 2024 – Sep 2025 **MR Scanner Operator** — University of Birmingham
Centre for Human Brain Health, University of Birmingham
Line Manager: Dr. Nina Salman

Oct 2021 – Sep 2023 **CINN Operations Support** — University of Reading
School of Psychology and Clinical Language Sciences, University of Reading
Line Manager: Prof. Anastasia Christakou

Apr 2021 – Oct 2021 **Junior Research Fellow** — University of Reading
School of Psychology and Clinical Language Sciences, University of Reading
Line Manager: Prof. Anastasia Christakou

Awards and Grants

2025 Google Cloud Research Credits Program (Google) £150

2024 Graduate Student Bursary for UK Ethnic Minority Groups (BACN) £300
Nationally competitive (1 awarded per year)

European Forum Alpbach Scholarship (Club Alpbach London) £2,500
Internationally competitive (5% acceptance rate)

2023 MRC AIM DTP Scholarship (MRC/University of Birmingham) £100,000
Internationally competitive

LGBT+ Inclusion Initiative Fund (University of Reading) £300

Teaching

2023- Magnetic Resonance Imaging in Cognitive Neuroscience, graduate course — University of Birmingham
Module convenor: Dr. Magdalena Chechlacz. Course website available here.

Jan – Apr 2023 Introduction to Neuroscience Methods, undergraduate course — University of Reading
Module convenor: Prof. Anastasia Christakou

Mentoring and Outreach

2024 – Student Mentor — Social Mobility Foundation

STEM Ambassador — STEM Learning
Giving talks to local schools on neuroscience and psychology

Project Access Mentor (Imperial/UCL/KCL) — Project Access

2023 – OHBM Mentoring Program — OHBM
Mentor: Dr. Marianna Kapsetaki (NKUA/Univ. of Crete). Mentee: Eleanor Benford (Univ. of Manchester)

Jul 2022 in2STEM Project Lead — in2Science
Lead organiser for the in2STEM summer program. Materials available here.

2022 – 2023 CINN Work Experience Placements — University of Reading
Organised and ran multiple work experience placements for college students

Memberships and Affiliations

2025 – Associate Member — The British Neuropsychological Society

2024 – LLM HPC Research Group — University of Birmingham

ReproducibiliTea Board Member — University of Birmingham

Board Member — Club Alpbach London

2024 – 2025 Student Representative — British Association for Cognitive Science

2023 – R User Group — University of Birmingham

Papers

Refereed Publications

2026

1. Lin, Z., and **Sohail, A.** (2026). *Recalibrating academic expertise in the age of generative AI*. Patterns, 7(1). https://doi.org/10.1016/j.patter.2025.101473

2025

1. **Sohail, A.,** and Zhang, L. (2025). *Using large language models to facilitate academic work in the psychological sciences*. Current Psychology, 44(9), 7910-7918. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12144-025-07438-2
2. **Sohail, A.,** Pancharatnam, R. A., and Kapsetaki, M. E. (2025). *Going With the Flow: Achieving Peak Performance in Surgery*. Journal of Surgical Education, 82(9), 103593. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jsurg.2025.103593
3. Rossetti, G. M. K., Dunster, J. L., **Sohail, A.,** Williams, B., Cox, K. M., Jewett, E., Benford, E., Lovegrove, J. A., Gibbins, J. M., and Christakou, A. (2025). *Evidence for direct control of neurovascular function by circulating platelets in healthy older adults*. The Journal of Physiology. https://doi.org/10.1113/JP288405

2024

1. **Sohail, A.,** and Zhang, L. *Informing the treatment of social anxiety disorder with computational and neuroimaging data*. Psychoradiology, 2024, kkae010. https://doi.org/10.1093/psyrad/kkae010

Preprints/Under review

2026

1. König-Kersting, C., Litovsky, Y., Böhm, R., Grossmann, I., Huber, J., Kirchler, M., & **WoCCAP Consortium**. (2026). *A many-designs study of 516 algorithms challenges the predictability of wisdom of the crowd forecast aggregation* (No. 2026-05).
2. **Sohail, A.,** Zhong, X., Konovalov, A., Lockwood, P. L., and Zhang, L. (2026). *Assessing mentalization in humans and large language models*. arXiv preprint arXiv:2608.26291.
3. **Sohail, A.,** Magda, A., Said, M., Phillips, L., Lu, Y., Reynolds, G., Comer-Fenn, A., Russell, J., Lu, H., Sims, T., Saulin, A. C., and Zhang, L. (2026). *Transdiagnostic factors differentially shape choices and reaction times in social evaluative learning*. PsyArXiv. osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/svbfw_v2

2025

1. Zhang, L., and **Sohail, A.** (2025). *BayesCog: A freely available course in Bayesian statistics and hierarchical Bayesian modeling for psychological science*. OSF. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/ua5ng_v1
2. **Sohail, A.,** Saulin, A. C., Karataş, K. F., Zhang, R., and Zhang, L. (2025). *Creating an engaging psychology-themed university placement for school students*. OSF. https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/4mcga_v1
3. **Sohail, A.** (2025). *Kierkegaardian anxiety in modern psychological research*. OSF. https://osf.io/dy92q_v1

Open Source Materials

2025

1. **Sohail, A.,** Quinn, A. J., Carpenter, J. J., Hansen, P. C., and Chechlacz, M. (2025). *MRI on BEAR (Birmingham Environment for Academic Research): Magnetic Resonance Imaging in Cognitive Neuroscience at the Centre for Human Brain Health*. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.15804715

Posters

2022

Rossetti, G. M. K., Dunster, J. L., **Sohail, A.**, Williams, B., Cox, K. M., Jewett, E., Benford, E., Lovegrove, J. A., Gibbins, J. M., Christakou, A. (2022). *Preliminary findings from the HAVEN Study: Investigating Haemostatic function, vessel health and neurocognitive health*. Interpreting BOLD III, Oxford, UK.

2021

Rossetti, G. M. K., **Sohail, A.**, Bell, T., Christakou, A. (2021). *Differential haemodynamics responses in the human striatum during initial and reversal learning*. Interpreting BOLD. Online. Available: here

Williams, B., Lee, O., Vanags, P., **Sohail, A.**, Brady, D., FitzGibbon, L., Christakou, A. (2021). *Test-retest reliability of model parameter estimates in human reinforcement learning*. Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science. Online

2016

Sohail, A., Myers, J. F. M., Mick, I., Clark, L., Bowden-Jones, H. M., Nutt, D. J., Lingford-Hughes, A. R., Turton, S. P. (2016). *Analysis of the reward system in Disordered Gamblers using MR and 11C-carfentanil PET*. British Association for Psychopharmacology Summer Meeting, Brighton, UK.

Skills

Programming – Python, R, MATLAB, bash, stan, LaTeX, HTML, JavaScript

Neuroimaging – FSL, SPM12, CONN, mricro, Trained MRI Operator (SIEMENS 3T PRISMA)

Research / Organisation – REDCap, SONA, Gorilla, Prolific, Pavlovia, Qualtrics, git/GitHub/GitLab, oTree, Heroku

References

Dr. Lei Zhang
Associate Professor
School of Psychology
University of Birmingham
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Professor Patricia L. Lockwood
Professor of Decision Neuroscience
School of Psychology
University of Birmingham
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